CLIENT SELF-HELP & COST-PROTECTION MASTER GUIDE · ENGLISH

Self-Represented Guide to Australian Forms, Fees & Inflection Points

A complimentary procedural manual covering Australian Immigration, Employment, and Family Law, helping you avoid legal fee inversion on routine steps and flagging when to consult Park & Co Lawyers at critical legal inflection points (effective 1 July 2026).

28d / 21d	**1 Jul 2026**	**Cost-Smart**	**Public Aid**
Strict ART & FWC Clocks	Verified FY 26–27 Court Fees	Prevent Legal Fee Inversion	CLC, Legal Aid & Regulators

Park & Co Lawyers · Complimentary General Legal Information (No Retainer Created)
Legal Practitioner Director: Chang Min Park (Accredited Specialist in Immigration Law, QLS) ·
https://parklawyers.com.au/links/

General Legal & Procedural Information Notice (No Retainer Created)
This complimentary guide is published by **Park & Co Lawyers** to help self-represented individuals protect their net financial outcome during straightforward or no-costs stages across Australian Immigration, Employment, and Family Law. Reading or downloading this manual does not create a solicitor-client retainer, and you remain responsible for monitoring your own statutory limitation dates and calculations. (Verified for FY 2026–27 effective 1 July 2026 · Official Hub: https://parklawyers.com.au/links/)

01 Non-Negotiable Statutory Deadlines Across All 3 Practice Areas

1. Immigration ART Appeals (Zero Extension Power)

- **Standard Migration / Protection (Part 5/7)**: **28 calendar days** from deemed notification
- **Applicant in Immigration Detention**: **14 calendar days** *(unified by 2025 Act)*
- **Onshore s 501 Character (s 500(6B))**: Strict **9 calendar days** + **2-business-day** evidence bar

2. Employment 21-Day Dismissal vs 6-Year Wages

- **FWC Unfair Dismissal (F2) & GP Dismissal (F8)**: Strict **21 calendar days** after dismissal takes effect
- **Court GP Filing After FWC s 368 Certificate**: **14 calendar days** (Form 2)
- **Unpaid Wages, Leave & 12% Super (s 548)**: **6 years** from each unpaid payday

3. Australian Family Law Separation & Property Bars

- **Online Divorce Application**: Minimum **12 months + 1 day** separation
- **Married Property / Maintenance (s 44(3))**: Within **12 months** after Divorce Order takes effect
- **De Facto Property Settlement (s 44(5))**: Within **2 years** from final separation

4. Home Affairs Responses, Judicial Review & Super Split

- **Departmental NOICC & s 57 / PIC 4020 Notices**: Strict timeframe on letter (typically **5 business days to 28 days**)
- **FCFCOA Migration Judicial Review (s 477)**: **35 days** from date of ART decision
- **Family Law Superannuation Splitting Orders**: Minimum **28 days** procedural fairness notice to Fund Trustee

02 Verified 1 July 2026 Official Forms, Filing Fees & DIY Checklists

Practice	Official Form & Portal	1 Jul 2026 Fee	Essential Self-Completion Rules & Common Mistakes to Prevent
Immigration	**Form 888** (Partner Witness) **Forms 80 / 1229 / 1447**	Free ($0)	• **Form 888 Reform**: No longer a statutory declaration (no JP required), but invalid unless witness photo ID + AU citizenship/PR proof are attached. • **Form 80**: Disclose 10 years of addresses, employment, travel, and unemployed gaps with zero missing months. • **Form 1447** (8503 waiver): Lodging Form 1447 does not grant a Bridging Visa.
ART Appeals	art.gov.au Online / **Forms M1·M2** + Fee Reduction PDF	**$3,727** (Reduced **$1,863.50**; 50% refund if won)	• Legacy Form M11 is retired. **You must pay at least 50% ($1,863.50) before midnight on the final day for a valid application.** • Protection (Part 7): $0 upfront ($2,293 only if unsuccessful) / Character: $1,195 (detainee $100).

Practice	Official Form & Portal	1 Jul 2026 Fee	Essential Self-Completion Rules & Common Mistakes to Prevent
FWC Claims	**Form F2** (UD) · **F8** (GP) · **F72** (Bullying) · **F75** (SH)	**$92.70** (F80 waiver) **Form F75 = $0 Free**	• High-Income Threshold **$190,100** / Unfair Dismissal Cap **$95,050**. • s 725 bars filing both F2 and F8 simultaneously / Form F72 requires current employment / Name exact Pty Ltd + ACN.
Wage Claims	**FCFCOA Originating Application + Form 5** (≤$100k)	<$10k: **$310** $10k–$50k: **$500** $50k–$100k: **$585**	• Strict s 570 no-costs forum: self-calculate shifts first using our 208-Formula Excel sheet (1 Jul 2026 NMW **$26.44/hr · 12% Payday Super**). • Cite **s 557C reverse onus** if payslips were missing or false (do not use Form 2).
Family Divorce	comcourts.gov.au **Online Divorce** (Sole or Joint)	Divorce **$1,170** (Concession **$390**)	• **10 June 2025 Reform**: Short-marriage (< 2 yr) counselling certificate repealed, and Sole applicants with children under 18 are excused from court attendance unless contested. • Both spouses must hold concession cards for $390 Joint reduction; never serve a Sole application on your spouse personally.
Consent Orders	**Consent Orders · PPP ≤$550k · s 60I FDR**	Consent **$215** Initiating **$455–$895**	• Private informal agreements are unenforceable; formalise broad agreements via **Court Consent Orders ($4,950 fixed fee + $215 court fee + stamp-duty exemption)**. • Give Super Fund Trustees **28 days** written procedural fairness notice and upload a word-for-word identical .docx draft.

03 Verified Free Public Legal Aid & Government Regulator Directory

ALL AREAS & IMMIGRATION

Public Legal Aid & Migration Centres

- **Legal Aid QLD**: 1300 65 11 88
- **CLCs QLD**: 07 3392 0092
- **RAILS (Migration/Refugee)**: 07 3846 9300
- **QLS Find a Solicitor (qls.com.au)**: 1300 367 757

EMPLOYMENT & SUPER

Workplace & Super Regulators

- **Fair Work Ombudsman**: 13 13 94
- **Fair Work Commission**: 1300 799 675
- **Basic Rights QLD**: 07 3254 1811
- **ATO Unpaid Super**: 13 10 20

FAMILY & MEDIATION

Family Dispute Resolution & Courts

- **Family Advice Line (s 60I)**: 1800 050 321
- **WLSQ (Women's Legal)**: 1800 957 957
- **Services Australia Child Support**: 131 272
- **Commonwealth Courts**: 1300 352 000

When to Consult Park & Co Lawyers: Immigration, Employment & Family Law Inflection Points

- **Complex Immigration (QLS Accredited Specialist):** NOICC cancellations, PIC 4020 / s 57 natural justice responses, in-time ART appeals, s 501 character, Schedule 3 or health waivers, and Employer Sponsorship (SID 482 / 186 / 494 · CSIT $79,423) → https://form.jotform.com/220391121528851.
- **Complex Employment & Family Law:** Corporate and Sponsor HR defence, 482/186 visa-linked dismissals (21 calendar days), and self-calculated >$50,000 / s 550 wage litigation (https://form.jotform.com/221642058161853) / Fixed-fee Consent Orders ($4,950) and non-responsive ex-partner financial disclosure demands or AU/international property settlements (https://form.jotform.com/262472844554060).
- **Official Consultation Hub:** Gather your decision record or notice PDF and earliest statutory deadline, then submit via https://parklawyers.com.au/links/ (**Chang Min Park**, Legal Practitioner Director, Underwood QLD).

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